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Lead Cyber, Governance, Risk and Compliance Manager

Department for Business and Trade

Apply before Midday on Friday 31st July 2026



Reference number

471789

Salary

£62,534 - £82,200

London: £66,257 to £82,200 / National: £62,534 £78,580 (including allowance). Your salary will be determined by your skills and capability as assessed at interview

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

DBT - CS - Digital, Data and Technology

Type of role

Information Technology

Security

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Belfast, Birmingham, Cardiff, Darlington, Edinburgh, London, Salford

About the job

Job summary

The Department for Business and Trade (DBT) has a clear mission - to grow the economy. Our role is to help businesses invest, grow and export to create jobs and opportunities right across the country. We do this in three ways.

Firstly, we help to build a strong, competitive business environment, where consumers are protected and companies rewarded for treating their employees properly.

Secondly, we open international markets and ensure resilient supply chains. This can be through Free Trade Agreements, trade facilitation and multilateral agreements.

Finally, we work in partnership with businesses every day, providing advance, finance and deal-making support to those looking to start up, invest, export and grow.

The Digital, Data and Technology (DDaT) directorate develops and operates tools and services to support us in this mission. The team have been nominated four times in a row for Best Public Sector Employer at the [Women in Tech awards](#) and won the award in 2025!

Job description

Ready to break out of environments where cyber is an afterthought? Join DBT and help mature a security capability in a department that values expertise, moves quickly, and gives you the autonomy to drive meaningful change. This is a place where your skills won't be sidelined, they'll set the direction.

As part of DBT's Cyber Security team, you will lead on Cyber Governance, Risk and Compliance within the Governance, Risk and Compliance (GRC) function. Reporting to the Head of Cyber Governance, Risk and Compliance you will work with colleagues across Digital, Data and Technology (DDaT), and the wider Government Security Profession across government.

The GRC team plays a critical role in establishing governance, managing cyber risk, and maintaining system security assurance. They also deliver GovAssure, security training and user education, maintain security policy, set compliance standards, and manage the delivery of cyber audits. Consequently, this role requires strong leadership and acumen across cybersecurity and corporate disciplines to actively shape governance practices and provide expert advice to inform senior decision-makers.

You will lead and support the uplift of organisational cyber posture within a broad remit, providing strong opportunity for personal development through empowerment to deliver within a growing government department. Indeed, in DBT we prioritise the wellbeing and careers of our Cyber professionals, with access to industry recognised training and civil service development pathways.

Main responsibilities

The post holder will be responsible for delivery across multiple areas within a complex cyber security portfolio. Experience across as many of the below as possible is desirable:

Risk Management: Undertake and lead complex cyber risk assessments, including, where applicable, tailored threat analysis, supply chain risk assessment, and compliance with legislation, regulation and policy.

Supplier Assurance and standards: Integrate assurance approaches to provide confidence that organisational security needs are met, aligning with UK Government standards such as the Government Security Policy Framework, ISO 27001, and NCSC Cyber Governance Code of Practice.

Digital Programmes: Provide cyber expertise and lead cyber delivery of key digital programmes of work across the organisation, ensuring all works are conducted cognizant of risk and in compliance with governmental standards and best practice.

Security Audits: Lead cyber audit activities, compliance reviews and penetration tests, including GovAssure and Secure by Design, collaborating with diverse stakeholders to implement mitigations through the programme lifecycle.

User Education: lead the strategic delivery of cyber security education and awareness across the organisation, developing auditable datasets

that identify key areas for improvement and evidence knowledge uplift iteratively.

Policy and Strategy: Champion and develop strategies, security policies, standards and procedures across the cyber governance, risk and compliance portfolio ensuring they remain responsive to evolving threats and business requirements.

Third Party engagement: Support arm's length bodies and partner organisations to uplift their cyber security posture, standardising and sharing knowledge to align with departmental approaches, governmental standards and best practice wherever possible.

Provide Expert Advice: Offer specialist cyber security and data protection guidance to risk owners and stakeholders, enabling informed, risk-based decisions.

Stakeholder Engagement: Build strong relationships with internal and external stakeholders, including senior leaders, to enhance organisational cyber security capability.

Promote Best Practice: Act as an advocate for cyber security best practice within DBT and across government, engaging with peers in the public sector and industry.

Person specification

It is essential that you have:

Proven experience in cyber security governance, risk, and compliance within complex or regulated environments. (Lead)

Demonstrable experience across cyber security or technology, evidenced through qualifications (e.g. undergraduate/ master's degree), relevant industry experience in positions such as systems, development, computer forensics, networking etc.

Excellent communication skills, with experience distilling complex issues and translating technical matters and cyber risks into clear briefings for senior stakeholders and deliverables for wider business.

Experience leading cyber security risk and assurance activities, collaborating with audit, legal, and compliance teams.

Experience leading and delivering large programmes across multiple teams and stakeholders.

It is desirable that you have:

Demonstrable experience delivering GovAssure and/or Secure by Design.

Experience delivering user education informed by data, using diverse engagement methods.

Relevant certifications such as CISSP, CISM, or CRISC.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Making Effective Decisions

Communicating and Influencing

Seeing the Big Picture

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Information risk assessment and risk management

applied security capability

protective security

threat understanding

Benefits

Learning and development tailored to your role

An environment with flexible working options

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

As part of the [application process](#) you will be asked to upload a two-page CV and complete a 1000 word personal statement outlining how you meet the essential skills and experience listed above. You can use bullet points and subheadings if you prefer.

Sift will be from week commencing 03/08/2026

Interviews will be from week commencing 13/08/2026

Please note these dates are indicative and may be subject to change.

If there is a high volume of applications, we will sift looking at your **First criterion - Proven experience in cyber security governance, risk, and compliance within complex or regulated environments. (Lead)** only. You may then be progressed to full sift or straight to interview.

At the [interview stage](#) for this role, you will be asked to demonstrate relevant Technical Skills and Behaviours from the [Success Profiles](#) framework. These are role specific and in line with the [Government Security Profession Career Framework](#).

You will also be asked to complete a Technical case study and will be informed on the topic following the sift.

How we Offer

Offers will be made in merit order based on location preferences. If you pass the bar at interview but are not the highest scoring you will be held on a 12-month reserve list in case a role becomes available. If you are judged a near miss at interview, you may be offered a post at the grade below the one you applied for.

This role requires [SC clearance](#). DBT's requirement for SC clearance is to have been present in the UK for at least 3 of the last 5 years. Failure to meet this requirement will result in your application being rejected and your offer will be withdrawn.

Checks will also be made against:

- departmental or company records (personnel files, staff reports, sick leave reports and security records)

- UK criminal records covering both spent and unspent criminal records

- your credit and financial history with a credit reference agency

- security services record

- location details

More about us

This role can only be worked from within the UK, not overseas. If you are based in London, you will receive London weighting. DBT employees are contracted to work in a hybrid pattern, spending 2-3 days a week (pro rata) in the office. Travel to your primary office location will not be paid for by DBT, but costs for travel to an office which is not your main location will be covered.

You can find out more about our office locations, how we calculate salaries, our diversity statement and reasonable adjustments, the Recruitment Principles, the Civil Service code and our complaints procedure on [our website](#).

The Department will not consider sponsoring a visa or issuing a Certificate of Sponsorship. We are unable to offer advice on any Visa and Immigration cases.

Find out more about life at DBT, our benefits and meet the team by watching our [video](#) or reading [our blog!](#)

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals

- nationals of the Republic of Ireland

- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

Please note this Post is NOT regulated by the Civil Service Commission.

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : DDaT Recruitment

Email : Ddat.recruitment@businessandtrade.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : Ddat.recruitment@businessandtrade.gov.uk

Further information

Our recruitment process is underpinned by the principle of appointment on the basis of fair and open competition and appointment on merit, as outlined in the Civil Service Commissioners Recruitment Principles. If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with these principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should in the first instance [contact DBT by email at Resourcing@trade.gov.uk](mailto:Resourcing@trade.gov.uk). If you are not satisfied with the response you receive, you can contact the Civil Service Commission, which regulates all Civil Service recruitment. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: [Civil Service Commission Complaints](#)

